

Which App?

When you sit down to use AI, your first decision is which app to download and use. Three dominate: ChatGPT from OpenAI, Claude from Anthropic, and Gemini from Google. All three can chat, write, code, and answer questions. So why does it matter which one you pick?



DIFFERENT PHILOSOPHIES

Think about it like this. In-N-Out and McDonald’s both sell cheeseburgers, built from roughly the same ingredients. They’re still completely different experiences, because each company has a different idea of what a burger place should be. One does a tiny menu with everything made fresh. The other is engineered for speed, scale, and being exactly the same in every city on Earth.

The big three AI apps work the same way. They’re all Generative AI, trained on much of the same internet. But each company trains its model with different priorities and rules.

Those choices shape much of how each app differs: how it feels, what it’s good at, and how it acts when it’s not sure. Underneath, each one is built around a different core philosophy.

The big three, side by side

CHATGPT The Anything Box	CLAUDE The Thinking Partner	GEMINI Built Into Google
WHAT IT IS One general-purpose AI app aimed at a wide audience. It’s still many people’s default starting point.	WHAT IT IS Built by Anthropic with an explicit safety-and-behavior philosophy. Often strong when careful reasoning and accuracy matter most.	WHAT IT IS Google’s AI assistant, strongest when the task connects to the Google tools you already use.
OPENAI ASKS <i>How do we put capable AI in everyone’s hands?</i>	ANTHROPIC ASKS <i>How do we build powerful AI we can actually trust?</i>	GOOGLE ASKS <i>How do we put AI inside the tools people already use?</i>

Each philosophy turns into a different kind of strength. ChatGPT is built for breadth. Claude is built for depth. Gemini is built for context.

WHICH APP SHOULD YOU USE?

Honest answer: for most of what you’ll do, any of the three works. Don’t agonize over the choice. There’s no single best app, and what’s best today might not be best tomorrow.

Pick one as your home base and learn it well: its settings, its features, its quirks. Knowing one app deeply beats dabbling in all three.

A power move for later: when an answer really matters, ask the same question in a second app. Two differently trained apps agreeing is real evidence. If they disagree, you know exactly where to dig.

A REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Hi. This is Nate and Luke again. When we built this course, we used different apps for different jobs. Our dad knows the strengths of each, and guided us into the right app for the task at hand.

ChatGPT	Claude	Gemini
✓ Brainstorming content and TRY ITs ✓ Illustrations of us in Dallas Stars jerseys	✓ Claude Code wrote all the code from plain English ✓ Claude Design styled the pages	✓ Pulling in current information ✓ Fact-checking what we used

We leaned on one more tool: NotebookLM, which is powered by Gemini. Its job was the videos in this course. We uploaded a lesson’s content, clicked a button, and NotebookLM did the rest.

Pick a home base. Learn it deeply.

The skills transfer. The app is just where you practice them.